Safety & ergonomics

Higher · Design · Worksheet

D&M WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ describe how ergonomics makes products safe, comfortable and easy to use
- ☐ use anthropometric data and choose the right percentile
- ☐ describe how safety has influenced the design of a product
- ☐ describe the influence of anthropometrics, physiology and psychology, linking body parts to product parts
- ☐ describe how safety is ensured in products (testing, BSI, CE marking)

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

The two chairs above.

1 Describe how anthropometrics and physiology have influenced the design of these chairs. (4 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

The seat height suits the popliteal height (knee to floor) so feet rest flat ✓. The seat width suits the hip breadth of a large adult ✓. The camping chair is light enough to carry with one hand to the campsite ✓. Only a low force is needed to fold and lock the frame ✓.

Why answers lose marks

"It is designed for the 5th to 95th percentile so it fits everyone."

0 marks: no body part linked to a product part.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

A family car dashboard and driver's seat.

2 Describe how ergonomics has influenced the design of the car interior. To gain full marks you must refer to anthropometrics, physiology and psychology. (6 marks)

Sentence starters

Anthropometrics: …
Physiology: …
Psychology: …

Word bank

Physiology · slides · different · pedals · lengths · drivers · Anthropometrics · psychology

Tip: 6 marks = 6 separate, developed points.

YOU DO **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) Which percentile is used to position an emergency stop button?
☐ 5th ☐ 50th ☐ 95th ☐ 99th

b) A bright red, clearly labelled off switch reassures the user. This is...
☐ Psychology ☐ Anthropometrics ☐ Physiology ☐ Function only

c) "The force needed to squeeze the trigger is low so the user does not tire" is an example of...
☐ Anthropometrics ☐ Physiology ☐ Psychology ☐ Aesthetics

d) Which feature mainly improves safety?
☐ Brand logo ☐ Guard over moving blades ☐ Glossy finish ☐ Secondary storage

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Anthropometrics**	____	**A** How a product's look, feel, sound, smell or taste affects the user.
2. **Physiology**	____	**B** 5th percentile, so smaller users can reach.
3. **Psychology (ergonomics)**	____	**C** Strength, effort, movement and strain required to use a product.
4. **Percentile for reach**	____	**D** 95th percentile, so larger users fit through or under.
5. **Percentile for clearance**	____	**E** The study of human body measurements used to size products.

5 Explain what is meant by ‘CE marking’. (2 marks)

6 Explain what is meant by ‘BSI’. (2 marks)

Check and reflect
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?